

and Dropbox and, most importantly, support for archives. In addition, the app has a pleasant interface that allows you to smoothly navigate to locations of your choice.

Link: <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.speedsoftware.rootexplorer>

SetCPU

Want to improve your device's performance and also save battery life? SetCPU is the app for you. It is an amazing application that allows you to overclock, underclock and tweak the voltage settings of your Android device. This app is most compatible with the HTC One series, Samsung Galaxy series and the Nexus Android devices. In addition to manual settings, you can also create user profiles based on certain conditions. For example, you can set a profile to become active when a certain application is launched, when the device temperature goes above a certain point, when the device battery is below a certain threshold or simply based on the time. The interface is quite intuitive and this app can be used by beginners as well. Simply put, SetCPU is one of the best apps. It will not only help improve the device's performance but also save battery life considerably. Remember that SetCPU's performance will solely depend on the Android device's hardware and although this app supports a number of devices, you are advised to evaluate the app before buying it as some features, such as undervolting, are available only for certain kernels.

Link: <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.mhuang.overclocking>

JuiceDefender Ultimate

As battery life is the main concern for any high-end Android device user, the Google Play store is filled with apps that claim to save your battery's life. Meet JuiceDefender Ultimate, the grandfather of all power saving apps on Android. JuiceDefender provides you an extensive array of features that enable you to tweak anything and everything that affects the battery.

Some notable features of this app are:

- Automated Wi-Fi control based on time and location
- The ability to create schedules for the night, weekends, 4G, etc
- Brightness control that protects your eyes in dim light and at night
- A Bluetooth control that can also automatically reconnect devices such as smart watches, headsets and handsfree cables when they get disconnected
- The timeout control to minimise the hassle of the lockscreen, or disable it altogether
- An extreme profile that tweaks your device to save the maximum possible battery

Though quite a few of its features are available in the other apps mentioned in this list, JuiceDefender is a very powerful application that helps you get the work done in a seamless way. Also, as with some other applications, you should check if your ROM is supported to make the most of this awesome app.

Link: <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.latedroid.ultimatejuice>

Adblock Plus

Tired of advertisements downgrading your browsing experience? For years, Adblock Plus has been the most popular ad-blocker available for Firefox, Chrome, Opera, Android and Internet Explorer. It is a very useful app for blocking banners, pop-ups and video ads. It is a one stop shop for protecting your privacy online. The best way to install Adblock Plus is to use the package installer on the website link mentioned here.

Adblock Plus blocks advertisements based on the activated filter lists. A filter list is an extensive set of rules that tell the Adblock Plus to allow or deny access to certain Web addresses. By default, two filter lists are enabled:

- An ad-blocking list selected based on your language
- The Acceptable Ads exception list

You can also create your own lists, and enable and disable them as you please.

Link: <https://adblockplus.org/en/androidinstall>

Diskdigger

Have you ever deleted a photo or file only to realise that you needed it again? In desktop operating systems, that isn't a big problem thanks to the Recycle Bin or Trash where these files are temporarily saved. In Android, however, if you delete something from the system file manager, it is deleted permanently and not moved to Trash. The best way to recover such lost files is the DiskDigger app that is available for tablets as well as smartphones. When you launch the app, you will be asked to specify a location where the file was initially deleted from. Once the scan is complete, you can even preview images in DiskDigger's internal preview. You can also filter files based on their type and size to make it easier to search for a missing file. You can select files from the filtered results too. To recover one or more deleted files, you have three options:

- Send it via email
- Upload it to an FTP server
- Save it locally to a folder

Although this app hasn't been around for a long time, it can be a lifesaver for most of us.

Links: <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.defianttech.diskdiggerpro> <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.defianttech.diskdiggerpro>

Apart from the apps mentioned in this article, there are several others that provide improved functionality through root access. Open source is all about exploring. You will find more root apps not only on the Google Play store but also on other store repositories such as Fdroid and individual websites. Happy exploring! 

By: Sharmishtha Jatar

The author is an open source enthusiast who loves to read up on science and technology. A science student herself, she has spent hours tinkering with several Linux distributions as well as Android, and wishes to share her knowledge in the true spirit of open source.